Weekly Note: 9.10.26

Impressive

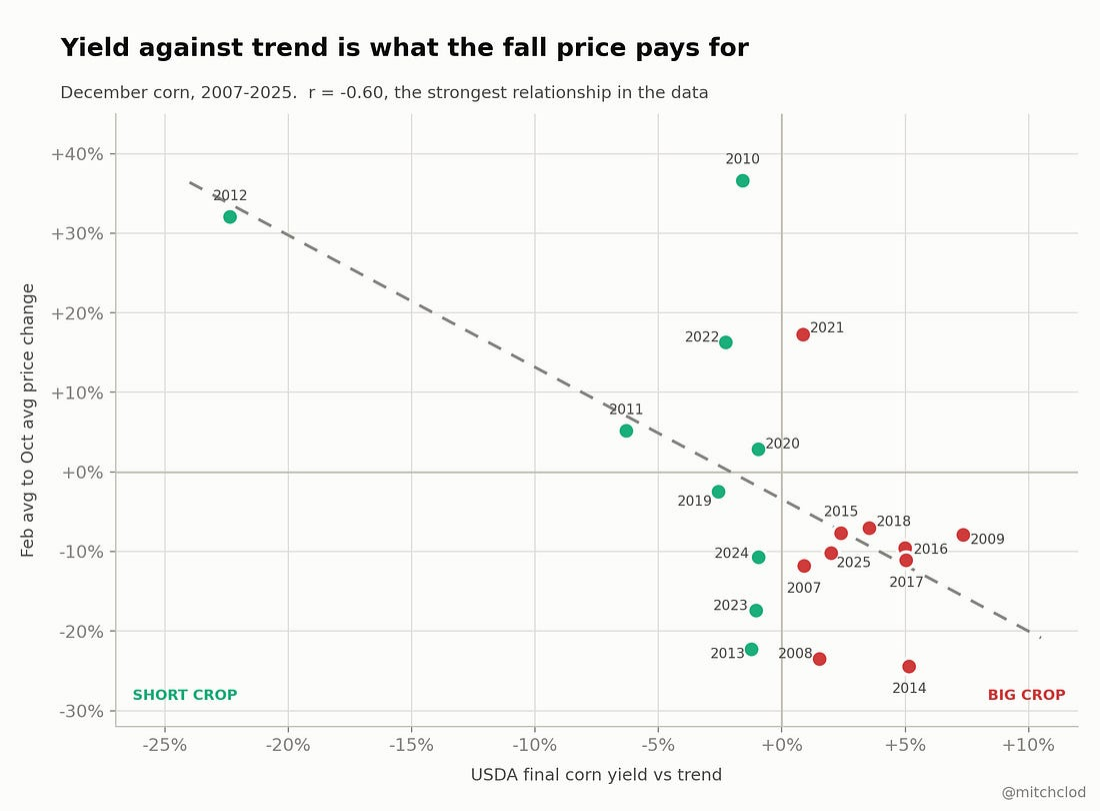


MITCH CLODFELTER

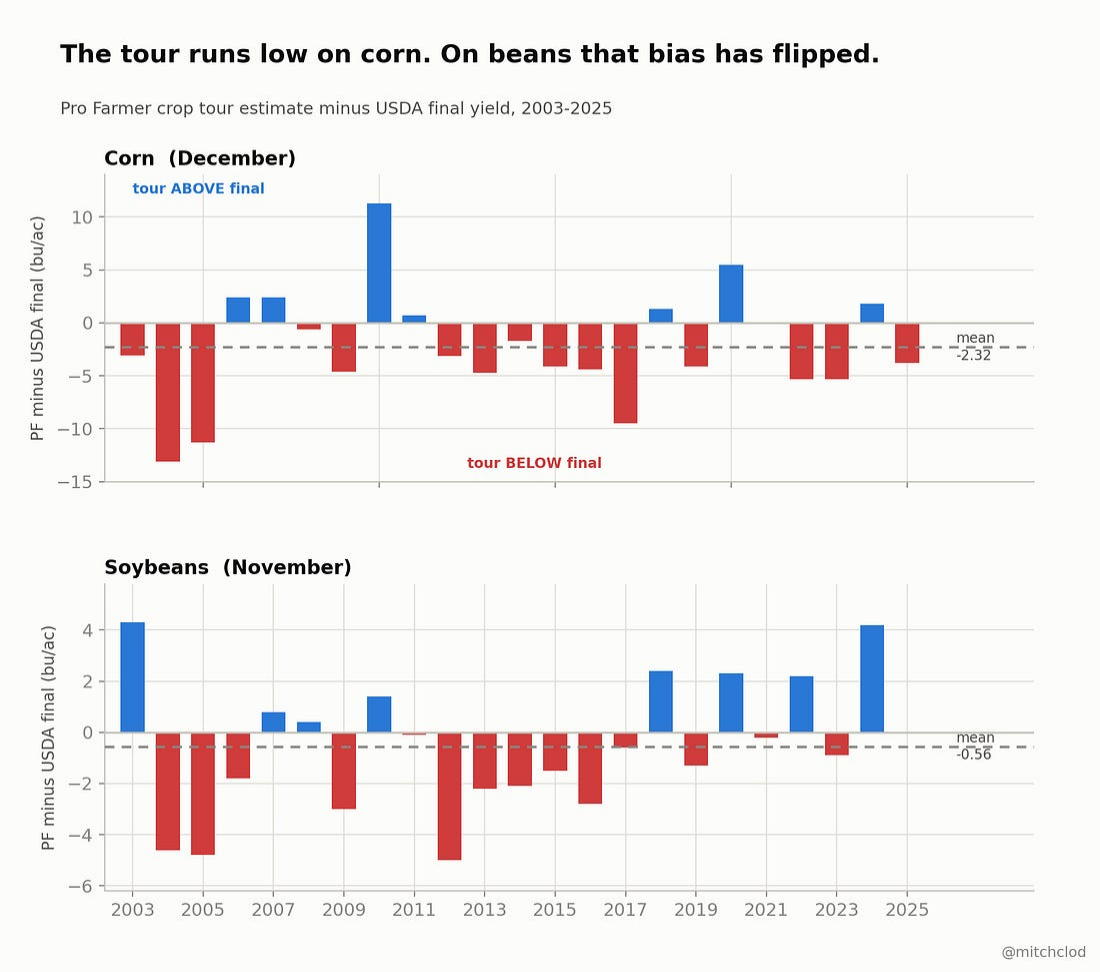
SEP 10, 2026

This week is a reminder that any and all technical analysis doesn't matter until the day it does. By almost any account, grains should be backing off here. They've been showing overbought for some time, with unproven yield data. And still they remain. Corn quietly lower on the week with beans higher. It's impressive.

I want to turn away for a moment from trade estimates for tomorrow's USDA report. Let's dig into a bit more of what happens this time of year vs. what actually happens to final yield. I'm not interested in the absolute accuracy of the tour or USDA, but rather how price moves in relation to those estimates. This is historical data collected by a colleague of mine that I analyzed using an LLM. Claude Opus 5 with a few parameters/skills to keep it on track.

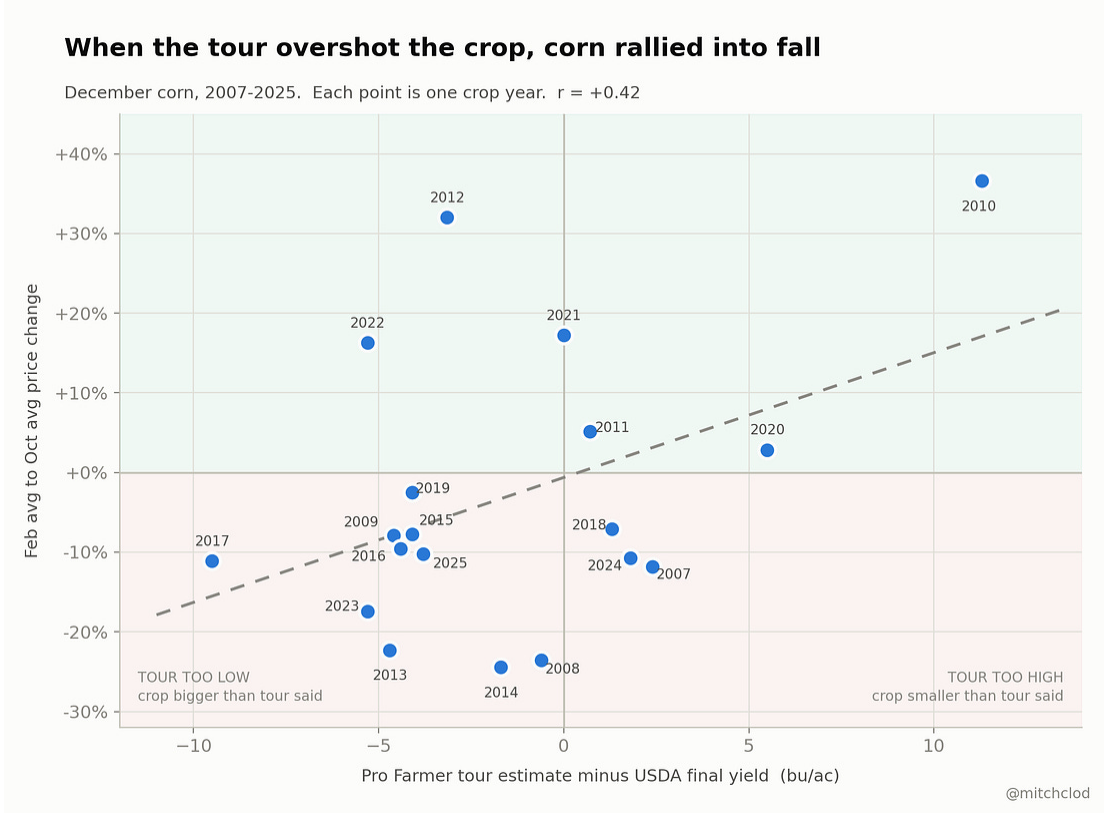


Price doesn’t pay for yield. It pays for yield vs trend. We know this already.

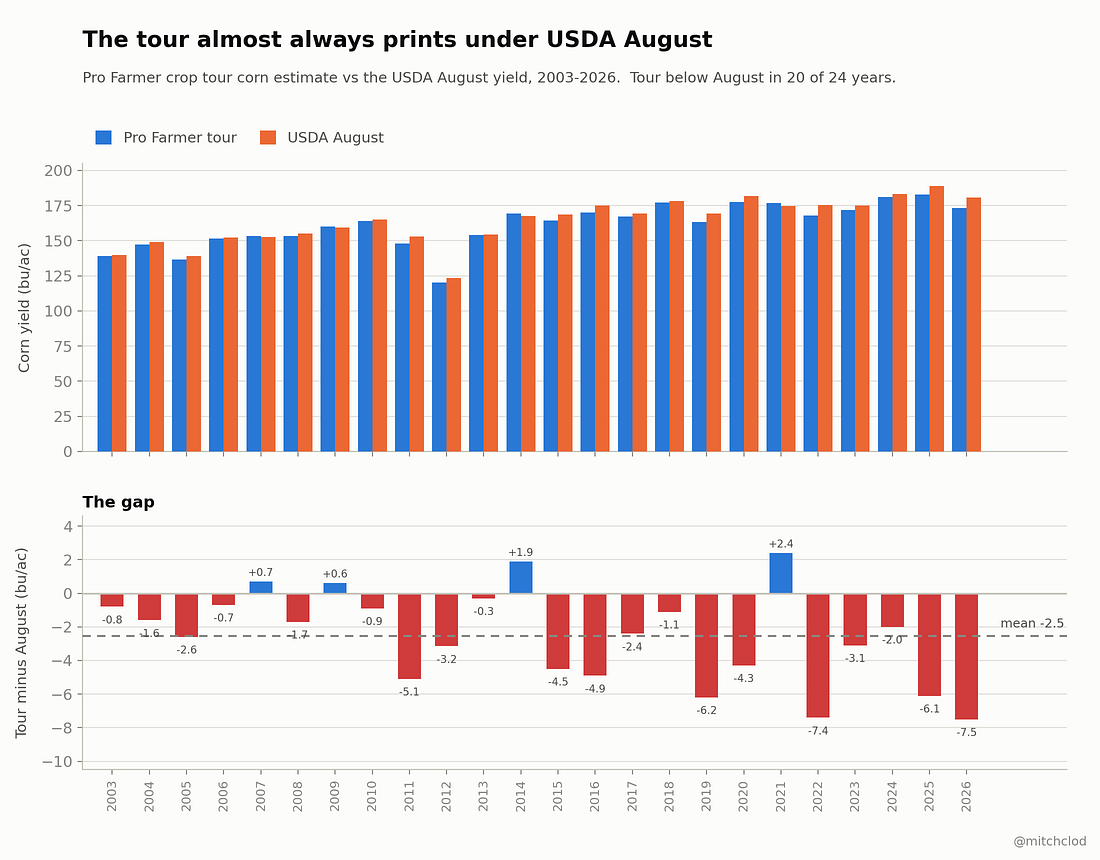


The tour tends to undershoot the crop. We knew this as well. But if we compare price action to a year they OVERSHOT the crop in 2010...





In 2010 we saw price rally into harvest and past. This is not 2010. The tour is the further under the August estimate that they have been in recent history.



Still there will be holes, Co-op yield tours in Illinois are showing a ~4% reduction in corn yield. Mid-Co, the risk management arm of Growmark, published the following tour results for Illinois:

MID-CO	Illinois Crop Tour Results				
Corn Yield	2026	2025	% Change YoY	2024	Notes
River Valley Coop - IL	199.0	218.0	-8.72%	220.5	
River Valley Coop - Iowa	200.0	217.8	-8.17%	223.4	
Tremont Coop	180.8	190.8	-4.56%	202.1	*90k Kernel
Premier Coop (Champaign)	231.0	232.0	-0.52%	249.0	*80k Kernel
Top Flight	186.3	193.0	-2.90%	194.0	*90k Kernel
Gateway FS (Christian)	215.0	211.0	1.72%	215.0	
Legacy Coop	204.7	208.3	-1.91%	212.9	*90k Kernel
Menard County FB	228.1	229.5	-0.66%	230.4	
Montgomery County FB	209.4	206.6	1.33%	192.0	*85k Kernel
Logan County FB	218.0	227.0	-4.32%	225.0	*75k Kernel
Coles County FB	218.1	226.9	-3.85%	217.9	*80k Kernel
Edgar County FB	191.0	212.0	-10.16%	218.0	*85k Kernel
First Mid - McLean	212.4	233.9	-9.37%	227.1	

MID-CO COMMODITIES, INC.

IL Crop Tour Yields				
	2026	2025	% Change YoY	2024
Average	207.21	215.91	-4.03%	217.48

USDA vs Crop Tour			
Illinois	2026	2025	2024
USDA Yield	212.0	214.0	217.0
Crop Tour*	207.2	215.9	217.5
Difference	-4.79	1.91	0.48

A notable reduction for notable counties. But let's put that on actual production weight by county.

COUNTY MAPPING AND 2023 NASS PRODUCTION WEIGHT

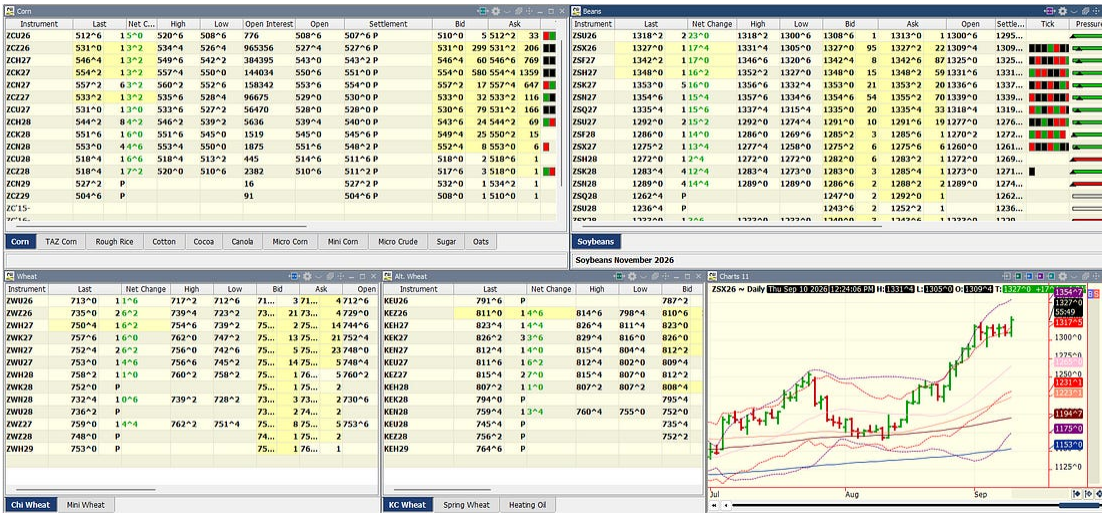
TOUR POINT	COUNTIES ASSIGNED	HARV. ACRES	2023 PRODUCTION	% OF IL
River Valley Coop – IL	Bureau, Henry, Stark, Knox, Whiteside, Peoria, Putnam, Marshall	1,145,900	250,833,000	11.02%
Premier Coop (Champaign)	Champaign, Vermilion, Ford	616,100	132,120,000	5.80%
Top Flight	Piatt, De Witt, Macon	361,400	81,927,000	3.60%
First Mid – McLean	McLean	315,000	70,336,000	3.09%
Legacy Coop	Shelby, Moultrie	249,500	51,057,000	2.24%
Gateway FS (Christian)	Christian	197,800	42,883,000	1.88%
Logan County FB	Logan	175,200	36,985,000	1.62%
Edgar County FB	Edgar	159,800	33,318,000	1.46%
Montgomery County FB	Montgomery	155,200	31,444,000	1.38%
Tremont Coop	Tazewell	140,000	31,079,000	1.37%
Coles County FB	Coles	115,900	25,649,000	1.13%
Menard County FB	Menard	76,500	16,402,000	0.72%
Total sampled	24 counties of 102	**3,708,300**	**804,033,000**	**35.32%**

STRAIGHT AVERAGE VERSUS ACREAGE-WEIGHTED, ILLINOIS ROWS ONLY

BASIS	2024	2025	2026	2026 YOY
All 13 rows, straight — as published	217.48	215.91	207.22	−4.03%
12 Illinois rows, straight	216.99	215.75	207.82	−3.68%
12 Illinois rows, acreage-weighted	220.75	217.39	206.95	−4.80%
USDA Illinois, for comparison	217.00	214.00	212.00	−0.93%

Right so weighting it by county production gives it a 4.8% decrease for 33.6% of Illinois harvested acres and 35.3% of the state's production in 2023. Not everything but not nothing.

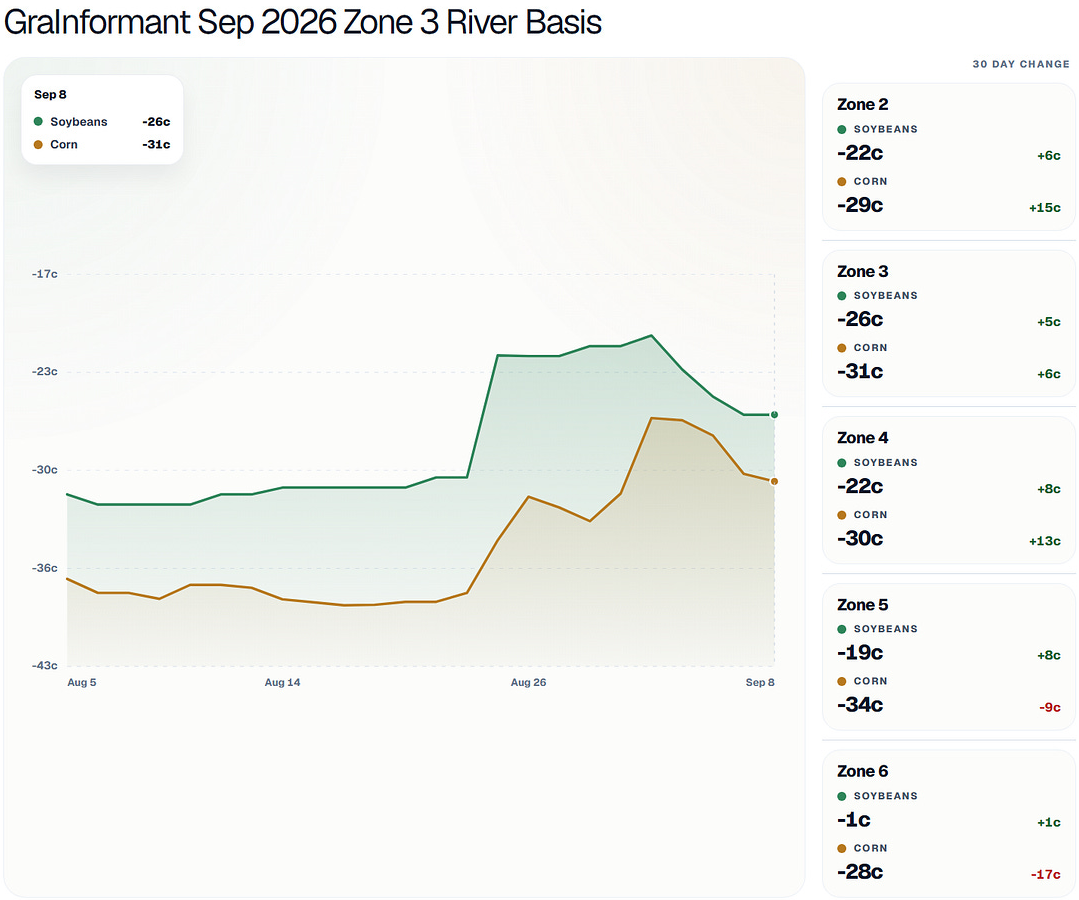
Back to Price



This week corn has been boorishly lower, and beans have performed the ‘picket fence’ maneuver, until today.

I recognize that there is more chatter than normal this year about yield reductions. The fact is we simply do not have all of the data yet. What corn has come off early in my area has exceeded expectations. Everyone is preparing for a lower corn yield in some area that is not their own.

They could be correct. We likely will see less corn this year. After an average crop last year. Basis is appreciating at the Illinois river.



Source | Grainformant.com

My risk management hat says prepare for everyone to be wrong.

In Summary

I threw a lot of charts at you this week, so I'll wrap this one up and let you chew. Yes, there is reason to believe that there will be a reduction in yield in key growing regions. However, at this time we do not have full confirmation of that and there are competing datapoints that point toward price moving differently for the next month. A bearish/neutral report tomorrow may mean the party stops for the time being. You do not have to be beholden to the 'what-if' of this market. Contact your broker to ask what they would recommend you do give your current

situation. There is a myriad of different positions that one might take. Find the one that works for you.

Some people believe that brokers exist to predict prices. That is my least favorite part of my job. I would much rather help someone decide what strategy works best for them given price on a certain date. What does price today mean for you?

Share

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Message Mitch Clodfelter